

Family and Community

CHAPTER

9

Love and dharma are the flower and fruit of family life.

— Tiruvalluvar

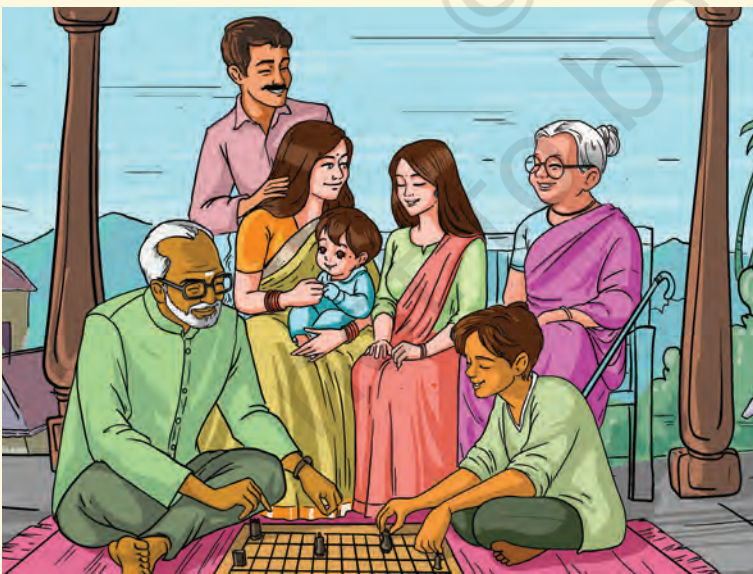
The Big Questions ?

1. Why is the family unit important?
2. What is a community and what is its role?

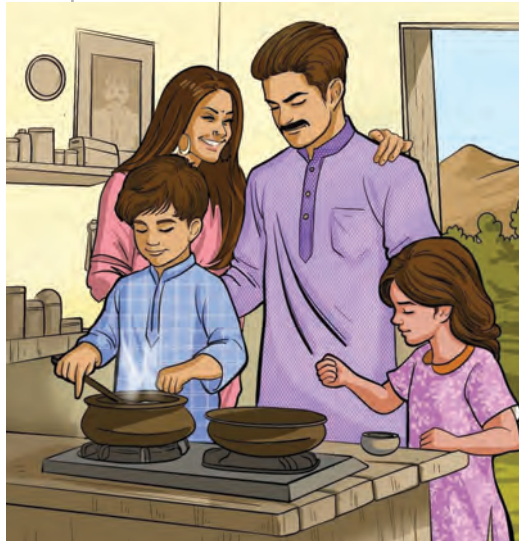


Family

Almost all of us live in a family. The family is the fundamental and most ancient unit of any society. In Indian society today, there are several types of families — from joint families to nuclear families. A joint family has several generations living together — grandparents, parents, uncles and aunts,



Examples of joint families



Examples of nuclear families

brothers, sisters and cousins. A nuclear family, on the other hand, is limited to a couple and their children, and sometimes one parent and children.

LET'S EXPLORE

- What types of families do you see in your neighbourhood? List the type with the number of households for each type.
- What types are more frequent? Why do you think this is so?
- As a class activity, compare with your classmates' findings and discuss.

In English, there are not many terms to describe family relationships; we saw some of them in the first paragraph. Indian languages have many more terms. For example, in Hindi there is *bua*, *tau*, *tai*, *chacha*, *mausi*, *nana*, *nani*, and many more. Some languages, such as Tamil, also have different terms for elder brother / sister or younger brother / sister. But what is the word for 'cousin' in an Indian language? In most Indian languages, you will find that there is no such word! That is because cousins are only 'brothers' and 'sisters'. This emphasises the deep bonds among all the children in the family.

LET'S EXPLORE

- Make a list of all the members of your family you can think of, including a few distant relatives. List their terms in your mother tongue or regional language and try to find the equivalent in English. Two examples are below for Hindi:

Name	Term in Hindi	Description / term in English
Rani	बहन	mother's brother's daughter (cousin) (among other possible meanings)
Sameer	चाचा	father's younger brother (uncle)

- Notice how, quite often, a single word in your mother tongue or regional language requires several words in English to give a precise definition.

Roles and Responsibilities

Relationships among family members are based on love, care, cooperation and interdependence. 'Cooperation' means 'working together'. Each member of the family has a role and responsibility towards other members. For instance, parents are responsible for raising their children to become happy individuals and responsible members of the society. But also, as children grow up, they take on more responsibilities in the home to help other family members — whether parents or a sister or a brother, etc. Through daily practice, children learn to participate in the life of the household. In many homes, children also learn some of the traditions and practices their family has been following for generations.



LET'S EXPLORE

Answer these questions and compare your answers with a few classmates:

- Who in your family decides what is to be bought from the market?
- Who cooks food in your home?
- Who is the oldest person in your family?
- Who cleans the floor in your home?
- Who washes utensils in your house?
- Who helps you to do your homework?

Following our dharma, or doing our duty, has been an important principle of Indian culture. The family is also a 'school', where children learn important values such as ahimsa, *dāna* (giving), *sevā* (service) and *tyāga* (sacrifice). Individuals in the family often give up their own needs to take care of the family's needs.

Let us see one such story.



Shalini lives with her family in a town in Kerala. Her father runs a small business and her mother is a teacher in a nearby school. Shalini has a younger brother. Her grandmother, Acchamma

(father's mother), Chittappa (father's brother or paternal uncle) and her Chitti (aunt or uncle's wife) live with them. They have a daughter, Shalini's cousin, who she calls Chinni. Shalini's uncle has just lost his job and her aunt is a homemaker. The whole family was preparing for the festival of Onam. Acchamma told Shalini's father that his brother was having financial difficulties, so they were not able to buy new clothes for the festival. When Shalini's parents took her and her brother shopping, they bought new clothes not only for themselves, but also for Chittappa, Chitti and Chinni. As a result, Shalini did not get the silk dress she had expected; she had to settle for a simple cotton one. Acchamma explained to Shalini that this is how families support each other and share what they have. Shalini did not mind her simpler dress. She was happy that everyone could get some new clothes.



LET'S EXPLORE

- Draw a simple tree of this family of seven members.
- Why do you think Shalini's parents bought clothes for everyone?
- What would you have done if you were in Shalini's place?

That story was set in Kerala. Let us now travel northeast, to a village in Meghalaya.

My name is Tenzing. I love the mountains we live in, though life is sometimes hard. My father runs a small grocery store. After my mother became busy in a local handicraft cooperative, making our beautiful traditional fabrics, wood carvings and other items for sale to tourists, my father joined in cleaning the house, taking care of our small vegetable garden





and other household chores. Often, he helps my grandmother prepare food for us all.

Grandmother always has all sorts of interesting stories to tell me, with humour and wisdom; no one seems to understand people better than her! Grandfather helps me with my homework and takes me to the school bus stop. He is also actively involved in social work in our colony and is always offering his help to others. For example, when there is a power failure in our area, he goes and registers a complaint at the nearby office. When our neighbours' house got damaged in a storm, he collected some money from the whole neighbourhood to help with repairs.

We are lucky that my parents can take care of our basic necessities like food and clothing. When any special expenses come up, I have often seen that they discuss them together. Mother says that we should always try to save some money for any unexpected needs that may arise in the future.



THINK ABOUT IT

- ◇ Why does Tenzing's father consult his wife for special expenses?
- ◇ How do you feel about his participation in household chores?
- ◇ What roles do the grandparents fulfil?

LET'S EXPLORE

- Create a story of a family somewhere in India, where we see some family values practised. Share it with your class either through writing or drawing.
- Stage a small drama with all your classmates around two or three families. The play you write could include some challenging situations that the families faced, and show how they are resolved.
- In the stories of Shalini and Tenzing, we see examples of joint families. What do you think are the aspects of modern living that make some couples opt for a nuclear family (i.e., living apart from older generations or other relatives)? What could be some advantages as well as disadvantages of the two kinds of families?



Community

Families are connected not only within themselves, but also with other families and the people around them. Such a group of connected people may be called a 'community' (there are other meanings for 'community', depending on the context). Members of a community come together for various reasons, like celebrating festivals and organising feasts, weddings and other events. In some villages, people come together to support each other with agricultural practices like land preparation, sowing and harvesting. Over time, communities often agreed upon some practices on the use of shared natural wealth and resources such as water, grazing lands and forest produce. This is the case with many tribal communities. To some extent, this remains the case in village communities in rural India today. Such practices — we may call them 'rules', though they were rarely written down — have provided communities a secure access to resources. But it also means that all families and

individuals within the community have specific duties to perform. Otherwise, the community will not function smoothly.

DON'T MISS OUT

- ❖ Year after year, the region around the town of Jhabua, in Madhya Pradesh, suffered from an acute water crisis. Following their *halma* (see facing page) tradition of coming together to support any individual or family in times of crisis, the Bhil community decided to plant thousands of trees in hundreds of villages. The Bhils also dug many trenches to conserve rainwater and created other water harvesting structures. They did not get paid for this work but did it as their duty towards their community and the environment. In the *halma* tradition, the objective is to serve Mother Earth. In 2019, Shri Mahesh Sharma of the Shivganga movement was honoured with the Padma Shri award for his transformational work with the Bhil communities.
- ❖ During the Chennai floods of 2015, roads turned to rivers and people could no longer move around. Almost all shops were closed and services interrupted. Many private groups, in particular spiritual and religious organisations, cooked large quantities of food and distributed it to people who needed it.
- ❖ There are many more such examples of people coming together to do something for the benefit of the community without expecting anything in return. Have you heard of any?

The real-life stories above illustrate community in a rural context. Community is also present in an urban context, although it may function a little differently. Let us see an example from another real-life story.



More than 20 years ago, in an area of Ahmedabad (Gujarat), Kamal Parmar, owner of a small auto-fabrication workshop, noticed a group of underprivileged children on the street. Some had dropped out of school, while others had never been to school. Kamal started giving them tuition from 5:30 to 9:30 pm every day, after his regular work hours. He also provided the kids with a free dinner. Soon, 150 children were attending those classes regularly and were deeply interested in the lessons!

A few teachers from a local school noticed the classes and joined the teaching for a while. One of them observed, “These children don’t get proper benches to sit on, have no ‘silence zone’ classrooms and the vehicles passing by make lots of noise, yet they pay all their attention to what the teachers tell them. This touched my heart. The love and affection I got from them was unbelievable.” Some older children who were attending regular schools also joined as volunteers to teach in Kamal’s classes. One of them remarked, “We went there to teach, instead we learnt a lot from them.”



- Discuss this story in your class. What kind of attitude towards the community does it reveal?
- What values get reflected in Kamal Parmar’s initiative?
- Think about those underprivileged children. Do you think society has been unfair to them?

- What should society do to make sure that all children get access to education?

New types of communities have also emerged in the last 30 or 40 years. Residents' Welfare Associations in many urban areas are examples of communities that make their own rules and regulations. Those could be rules about waste management, cleanliness of common areas, taking care of pets, and so on. People living in the community participate in making such rules and regulations.

Communities are ultimately interdependent. The same Residents' Welfare Associations, for instance, will depend on the trading community for supplies and also on municipal workers to handle waste. In our complex societies, everyone depends on a number of other people and communities.



LET'S EXPLORE

Make a list of all people outside your family that are supporting you through their work in one way or another.

We now understand that 'community' is a flexible concept. A few more examples:

- A *jāti*, or a subdivision of it, is also often called a community.



- A group of people of a particular religion, region, common work or interest, especially a smaller group, may also be called a community; for instance, 'Mumbai's Parsi community', 'Chennai's Sikh community', 'America's Indian community', 'Kerala's scientific community', 'our school's art community', 'the village's farming community', and so on... The list is endless!
- In your school, you may be part of different communities — your class, of course, but also the sports community, the National Service Scheme, the National Cadet Corps, a science or drama club, etc.



LET'S EXPLORE

- What types of communities are you part of?
- Is there a club that you are a part of in school? How does it function?



Before we move on ...

- Family is the foundation of human society. Ideally, members of a family support each other in their many duties and tasks.
- Community, a bigger unit, also implies that people do their best to support each other. 'Community' can be defined in several ways and there are many kinds of community.
- Ultimately, communities are interdependent.

Questions, activities and projects

1. What are some of the rules you follow in your family and neighbourhood? Why are they important?
2. Do you think some rules are unfair to a few people in the family or community? Why?
3. Describe several situations that you have observed where community support makes a difference. You can draw or write about these.

The Value of Work

When you are doing any work, do not think of anything beyond. Do it as worship, as the highest worship, and devote your whole life to it for the time being.

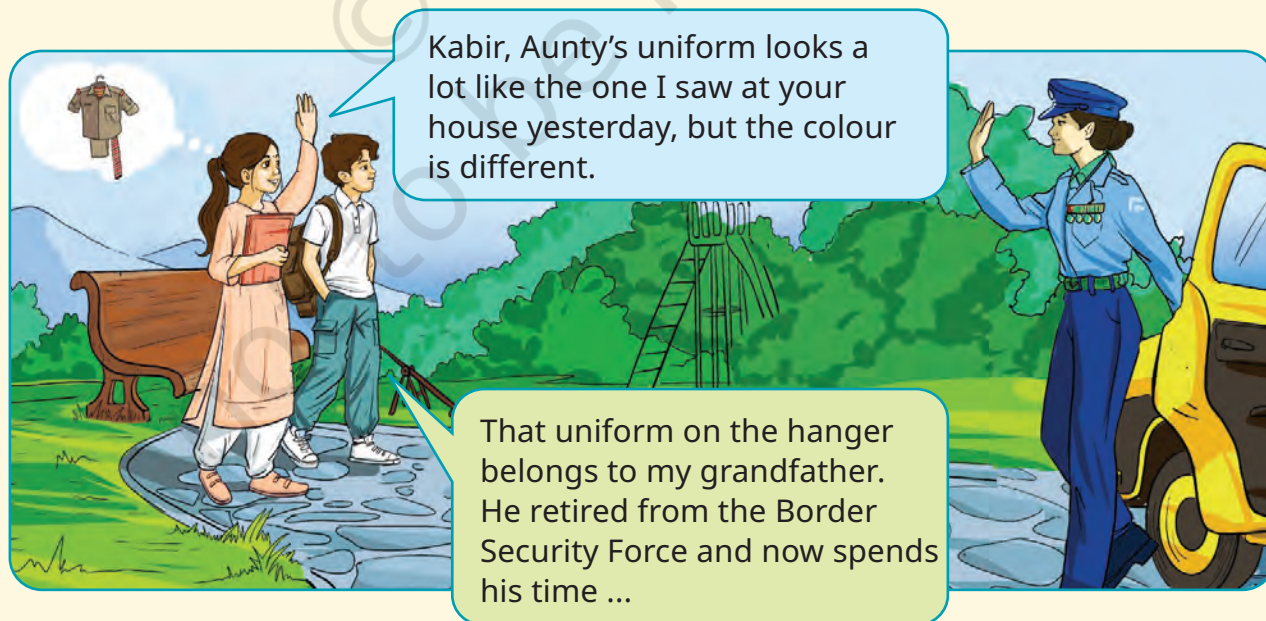
— Swami Vivekananda

The Big Questions ?

1. What are the different types of activities that people engage in?
2. What is their contribution to our everyday lives?



Anu and Kabir were playing in the park when they saw their neighbour, Geeta Aunty, getting out of a taxi. She was returning home from work and was in her uniform. A pilot in the Indian Air Force, she is the pride of the whole town.





... providing free Geography classes to the neighbourhood kids ...



... tending to our vegetable garden, and ...



... running errands for the home.



My parents run a shop that sells uniforms and other ready-made garments. Appa leaves early in the morning and Maa joins him in the shop after we leave for school.



Maa is usually back by the time we return home from school. She also contributes to a voluntary group that teaches knitting to the women in the community.



Do you remember my elder brother Rohan? You met him when he came to pick me up from school. He is a software engineer and works in a company that makes computer applications. On the weekends he volunteers to teach computer skills to those who have joined the youth development programme of the nearby college.



Wow, Anu, everyone around us does so many things every day!

LET'S EXPLORE

What activities did the people in Anu's and Kabir's story engage in? Mention them in the table given below:



Character in the story	Activities they are engaged in	

Different types of activities, like the ones discussed above, are divided into two groups or categories: *economic activities* and *non-economic activities*.

Economic activities are those that involve money or are performed in exchange for money or **money's worth** for the parties involved. For example, a business person selling school bags in the **market**, a farmer selling produce in the market, a lawyer arguing a case and earning a **fee**, a truck driver transporting goods from one place to another, workers employed in a car manufacturing factory, etc.

Money's worth: The monetary value that a person places on an object based on the benefit that they derive from it.

Market: A place where people engage in the exchange of goods and services. People may exchange goods and services for other goods but in most markets these are exchanged for money.

Fee: A payment made to a person or organisation in exchange for professional advice or services. For example, a fee paid to a doctor and a lawyer.

Non-economic activities are those that do not generate income or wealth but are done out of feelings like gratitude,

*Left to right, top to bottom:
A business person selling
school bags in the market*

*Farmers selling their
harvest in the market*

A lawyer arguing a case

*A truck driver transporting goods
from one place to another*

*Workers employed in a car
manufacturing factory*



love, care and respect. For instance, parents cooking food for the family or helping their children with schoolwork, youth taking care of the grandparents, family members helping in the renovation of the house, etc.

*Left to right:
Parents cooking food
for the family*

*Mother helping her
children with
schoolwork*





Left to right:

Youth taking care of the grandparents

Family members helping in the renovation of the house

LET'S EXPLORE

In the table given on page 185, did you notice the third empty column? Label this column 'economic / non-economic activity'. Now classify them according to the nature of activity.

In Anu's and Kabir's story, Geeta Aunt, the Air Force pilot, receives a **salary**. She serves the country and performs an economic activity too. Anu's brother, Rohan, works for a software company and is given a salary for it. Over the weekend, he also volunteers at the youth development programme of the nearby college, where he teaches computer skills to young adults. This is a non-economic activity.

Salary:
A fixed regular payment generally paid monthly by an employer to an employee.

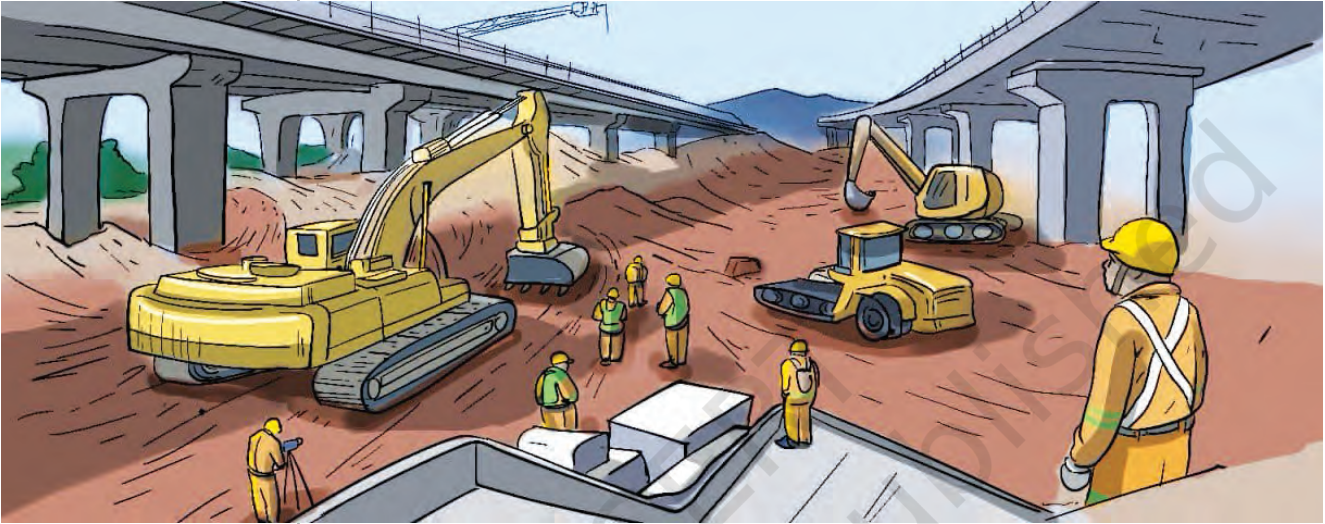


THINK ABOUT IT

- ◆ When Kabir's grandfather voluntarily teaches the neighbourhood kids for free, is that an economic activity or a non-economic activity? How is it different from your teachers teaching you at school? Discuss with your classmates.
- ◆ What are some non-economic activities that are important to you and your family? Why are they valuable?

Types of Economic Activities

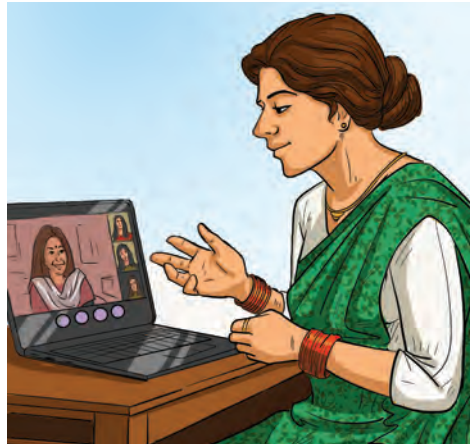
Kavya was excited to go to her aunt's house in the village of Kamlapur. On the way, she saw that a highway was being built near the village, and the construction site was abuzz with activity. Large machines, such as excavators and bulldozers, were being operated by dedicated technicians.



This new highway promised to reduce the travel time to the nearest town from five hours to just two hours. Kavya thought that she would be able to visit her aunt more often once the highway was ready, since it would take less time to travel there. Happy with this thought, Kavya ran to greet her aunt and to eat the delicious *jalebis* that she had made. They were joined by Kavya's uncle, who had just returned home from work. He

is a technician in a construction company and operates a bulldozer. He receives a monthly salary for his services.

The next day, Kavya's aunt woke up early to finish her share of the household chores and left for work. She is



employed at the village post office and is paid a monthly salary. In the evening, after her office work, she also conducts online classes to help students prepare for school exams. She charges a weekly fee for these classes.

On the weekend, Kavya visited a local mango orchard with her aunt to have some delicious mangoes.

There she saw Sahil, a farm labourer who was using a tractor to till a farmer's land nearby. He earns a daily **wage** for his efforts. He gets some payment for his work in cash, and the remaining part of the payment in the form of mangoes of equal value. The mangoes that he receives as a part of his work are called **payment in kind**.



Wage:
A payment made by the employer to the worker for a specific period of time.

Payment in kind: A non-cash payment that is received for the work performed.



THINK ABOUT IT

On your way from home to school today, can you recall the various economic activities that people are engaged in? In what ways do you think those people are paid?

As we now understand, economic activities are those that have value in terms of money. Economic activities also add value at each stage of the process of transforming something into another form. This is called value addition.

Let us take the example of Kavya's father, Rajesh, to understand this.



Rajesh is a carpenter who buys wood from a nearby market for ₹600 to make furniture.



He uses special tools and other materials for building the furniture.



Rajesh sells a chair for ₹1,000 each in the market.

The wood for the chair costs ₹600. So, what is the remaining ₹400 ($₹1,000 - ₹600$) for? It is the monetary value of Rajesh's skill, time and effort, which went into making that chair. Rajesh has added value to the wood by turning it into furniture. From buying the wood to selling the chair, these activities involve payment. They are, therefore, a part of economic activities.

LET'S EXPLORE

Put a ✓ against those activities/professions that you think create monetary value. Can you add two activities and examples of money related value creation to the empty rows at the end?



Activity / Profession	Example of money-related value creation
1. Baker	
2. Tailor	
3. Farmers repairing their tractor	
4. Doctor	
5. Parents cooking dinner for their family	
6. Scientist	
7. Person taking care of a sick grandparent	
8.	
9.	

The Importance of Non-Economic Activities

While non-economic activities may not involve money, the value they generate is important in our lives.

Sevā: selfless service

We see sevā in many places such as temples, gurudwaras, mosques and churches. For instance, *langars* or community kitchens at gurudwaras serve food to every visitor for free. These practices foster a sense of satisfaction and gratitude

for what we have, and they are also a way of contributing to society without expecting anything in return.



Temple distributing prasād to devotees



Langar at the Golden Temple



Swachh Bharat Abhiyan



Van Mahotsav

The strength of community participation

The Swachh Bharat Abhiyan is based on the collective efforts of all Indian citizens to keep our surroundings clean. Individually, we keep our homes and surroundings clean. People have also come together to clean up streets, roads, parks and other public places or community areas. Together, these efforts lead to a clean home, neighbourhood, society and nation.

Another example of collective community participation is the celebration of Van Mahotsav (the festival of forests) in India to promote awareness about the value of trees and the conservation

of forests. The initiative brings together members of the community for tree plantation drives.



THINK ABOUT IT

- ❖ Many communities in India have similar practices that involve community participation. Can you identify a few from your area?
- ❖ We celebrate many festivals in India. During these festivals, people gather to organise all the various activities. They decorate the place together and share the food that they cook. Are these non-economic activities? Why do you think they still hold value?
- ❖ Can you identify community programmes that have been undertaken by your school or in your locality? What did you observe during these programmes?

Before we move on...

- In this chapter, we learnt about economic and non-economic activities.
- We also learnt about the value addition that economic activities create.
- We understood how non-economic activities contribute to social welfare, personal wellbeing and enhance the overall quality of life.



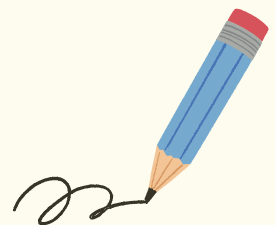
Questions, activities and projects

1. How are economic activities different from non-economic activities?
2. What kind of economic activities do people engage in? Illustrate with examples.
3. There is great value attached to people who are engaged in community service activities. Comment on this statement.
4. What are the various ways in which people are compensated for various economic activities? Give some examples.

Noodles

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*'Noodles' is our abbreviation for 'Notes and Doodles'!



Economic Activities Around Us

The root of prosperity is economic activity, the lack of it brings material distress. The absence of fruitful economic activity endangers both current prosperity and future growth.

— Kauṭilya's Arthaśāstra

The Big Questions ?

1. How are economic activities classified?
2. What differentiates these activities to be grouped into sectors?
3. How are the three sectors interconnected?



Introduction

In Chapter 13, we learnt about two types of activities – economic and non-economic. Activities that create **monetary value** are called economic activities. We also learnt about the importance of non-economic activities. To understand these activities better we will learn how economic activities are classified and what differentiates them in this chapter.

Monetary value: Value of something that can be measured in terms of money.



Economic Sectors:
Broad groups that include various activities that help with the economic prosperity of a nation.

Over the decades, the number of economic activities has increased tremendously. For example, earlier most people were involved in activities such as agriculture, livestock rearing, production of tools, pottery and weaving cloth. As societies progressed, the number of economic activities through which people earn their livelihoods increased vastly.

Today, there are diverse economic activities such as manufacturing computers, mobile phones and drones; working in banks, schools and hotels; driving various types of vehicles for transportation; making furniture; tailoring clothes using machines; creating software; repairing refrigerators and washing machines; etc. Classifying all these activities helps us to understand how they function and the links they have with each other.

The Classification of Economic Activities into Economic Sectors

Some economic activities share similar characteristics and based on this, they can be grouped together or classified into broader groups called **economic sectors**. The three main types of economic sectors are primary, secondary and tertiary economic sectors.

The illustration on the facing page maps out the broad activities under these categories.

A. Primary activities

Those economic activities in which people are directly dependent on nature to produce goods are known as **primary activities** or **primary sector economic activities**.

Primary sector:

The group of activities that involves extraction of raw materials directly from nature such as farming, fishing, forestry, etc.

Classification of economic activities into economic sectors

Primary sector



Agriculture



Mining



Fishing



Raising livestock



Forestry

Secondary sector



Construction



Manufacturing



Water supply



Solar power



Electricity production

Tertiary sector



Healthcare



Trade and logistics



Communication



Banking



Transportation

For example, work involving cultivation of grains and vegetables from agricultural farms, collecting wood from the forests, extracting coal from mines, fish from fisheries, eggs from poultry farms, etc., are all primary sector economic activities.

The most common primary activities are agriculture, mining, fishing, raising livestock, forestry, etc. Below are some of the types of activities within the primary sectors.



Greenhouse farming



Mining



Fish farming (fishery)



Forestry



Raising livestock



THINK ABOUT IT

Can you think of any primary activities that you may have seen in the past? What are the natural resources used in these activities? Name two of them and discuss your experiences with your classmates.

- 1.
- 2.

B. Secondary activities

Economic activities in which people are dependent on outputs of the primary sector and transform them to produce goods are known as **secondary activities** or **secondary sector economic activities**. The secondary sector includes the construction of buildings, roads, etc., and providing utilities like water, electricity, gas and other such necessities. It also includes the manufacturing of products in factories and production units to process raw material from the primary sector into some other form that can be further sold or consumed. Some examples of secondary sector activities include the processing of grains obtained from agricultural fields to make flour in mills, extraction of oil from groundnut and processing of tea leaves to derive tea. Similarly, wood from the forest is converted into furniture and paper, cotton is used to make clothes, and steel from iron ore is used to make automobiles like cars, trucks, etc.

Secondary sector:

The group of activities that involves processing of raw materials derived from primary sector into products for sale or consumption.



Automobile factory



Textile factory



Pharmaceutical factory



Furniture production unit



DON'T MISS OUT

Types of Automobiles	No. of units produced in India in 2022
Passenger vehicles like cars	45 lakhs
Commercial vehicles like trucks	10.3 lakhs
Three wheelers	8.6 lakhs
Two wheelers	2 crores

(Source: Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers,
<https://www.siam.in/statistics.aspx?mpgid=8&pgidtrail=13>)

LET'S EXPLORE



Now that we have seen some examples of secondary sector activities, can you name two more economic activities in the secondary sector?

- 1.
- 2.

C. Tertiary activities

All those economic activities that provide support to people involved in primary and secondary activities are called **tertiary activities** or **tertiary sector economic activities**. These include services that we may not be able to see but which still play a very important role. For example, the driver of a truck transports grains and vegetables from the farm to a factory or the market.

The fruit or vegetable vendors sell the farm produce to household consumers. Similarly, doctors, nurses, teachers, lawyers and pilots provide their services to those who need them. There are technicians who repair and service electronic items including mobile phones and televisions, mechanics who repair vehicles like cars and tractors, and electricians who ensure regular supply of electricity. Their services make our lives easier. Similarly, communication services through mobile and internet, software development, and services at hotels, restaurants, banks, schools, hospitals, airports, shops, **warehouses**, etc. are all examples of tertiary sector economic activities. This sector is also called the **service sector**.

Tertiary Sector:

The group of activities that involves the provision of services which complement both primary and secondary sectors, such as transportation, banking, and management of business.

Warehouses:

Large buildings used for storing products before they are sold, used or rented out to shops.



Software development



Services at restaurant



Services at airports



Retail stores

Interdependence Among Sectors

The three types of economic activities or economic sectors play an important role in the process of conversion of natural raw materials into finished products for final consumption. Let us go on an imaginary excursion to a village in Anand district of Gujarat to study an interesting example where we will understand how the three sectors are interconnected and support each other.

Dairy cooperative: from farm to plate

These days, farmers in Gujarat greet the day with the clinking of milk pails and the happy moos of their best friends, their cows or buffaloes! Cows have a special place in the lives of the farmers and their families. The farmers milk the cows and sell their milk to the **dairy** nearby. At the end of the month, they get paid for the milk based on its quantity and quality. However, this was not the case about 50 years ago.

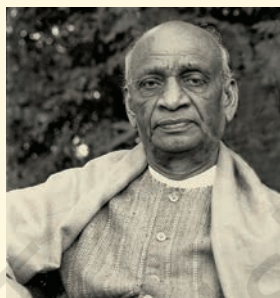
This is the amazing story of a milk cooperative named Anand Milk Union Limited (AMUL). In the early 1940s, farmers in Anand district would sell milk to the neighbouring villages.

Dairy:
A place
where
milk is
collected
and
stored.

They would have to cycle or walk to nearby villages to sell the milk under scorching heat. As you know, milk spoils or curdles very fast in hot weather. The farmers had to sell the milk quickly before it could spoil. This was a lot of effort for the small amount of money they would earn. So, they depended on people called middlemen, who would buy the milk in bulk at meagre prices from the farmers and sell it in the market. Many times, the farmers felt cheated and harassed by the middlemen.

One day, the farmers collectively approached Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, a prominent national leader, with their problems. He advised them to form a **cooperative** to become independent and stop relying on the **middlemen**. As a cooperative, the farmers would be able to collect milk as a group, taking care of the entire operation of milk collection, processing and distribution themselves. The farmers took Sardar Patel's advice.

AMUL was set up in 1946 under the leadership of Tribhuvandas Patel (lawyer and freedom fighter) and Dr. Varghese Kurien (an engineer who was working at a dairy factory in Mumbai).



Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel



Varghese Kurien (left) and Tribhuvandas Patel (right)

Cooperative:

A group of people who voluntarily come together to meet their economic and social needs in a formal way. They own the cooperative and decisions are taken by the members collectively.

Middlemen:

Persons who buy goods from producers and sell them to consumers. The middlemen charge a fee for this service.

Pasteurisation:

A process by which milk is preserved through heating to a specific temperature to kill harmful bacteria.

Factory: Building or group of buildings where goods are manufactured, or various components are put together, to make a final product.

Retail: The sale of goods in small quantities for use by the end consumer rather than for resale.

Export:

Goods and services that are produced in one country and sold to buyers or consumers in another country.

This initiative brought farmers, including women, together and gave them control over the production and sale of milk. The milk producers collectively made their own decisions on all matters such as production, **pasteurisation** and sale of milk. The tasks were shared by everyone, which helped raise their income gradually. They did not need the middlemen anymore and became like one big family!



As more and more farmers began to see the benefits of the cooperative, it continued to grow. The quantity of milk that was being collected was so huge that the farmers decided to make other products out of it. They set up a **factory** in Anand, and began to produce butter and milk powder.

Today, the cooperative has a wide range of products made at many milk processing plants and factories all over India. Can you name a few? The products are then transported and sold in both small and large **retail** shops

all over the country. In fact, they also **export** the products to several countries around the world. Is it not amazing?

In this fascinating story, the farmers of this cooperative milk their cows to sell the milk later. This kind of economic activity is called a *primary sector economic activity* because the product (milk) is derived directly from a natural source (cows/livestock).

Milk is then processed and converted from one form (liquid) into another — milk powder, ghee, cheese, butter and many others in the factories. These economic activities are called *secondary sector economic activities*.



What does AMUL do with all the products it makes? It sells them in various places. AMUL uses lorries and trucks, as well as railway, air and shipping services, to transport its products. It has set up retail stores and supplies milk and milk products to other shops in towns, cities and villages all over Gujarat, as well as in different states across India. Here, transportation, trading and retail is a *tertiary activity*.



DON'T MISS OUT

Just like AMUL, there are many other milk cooperatives under brands such as Nandini from Karnataka, Mother Dairy from Delhi-NCR, Aavin from Tamil Nadu, Vijaya from Andhra Pradesh, Kevi from Nagaland, Sudha from Bihar, Verka from Punjab, etc. Can you name one cooperative around you that has helped groups like farmers, persons with disabilities, and women, to come together and has brought prosperity to their lives?

With the help of the images below, let's see how the books you study are made. The images show the transformation of pulp (wooden fibre of a tree) into paper and, after printing, into textbooks.

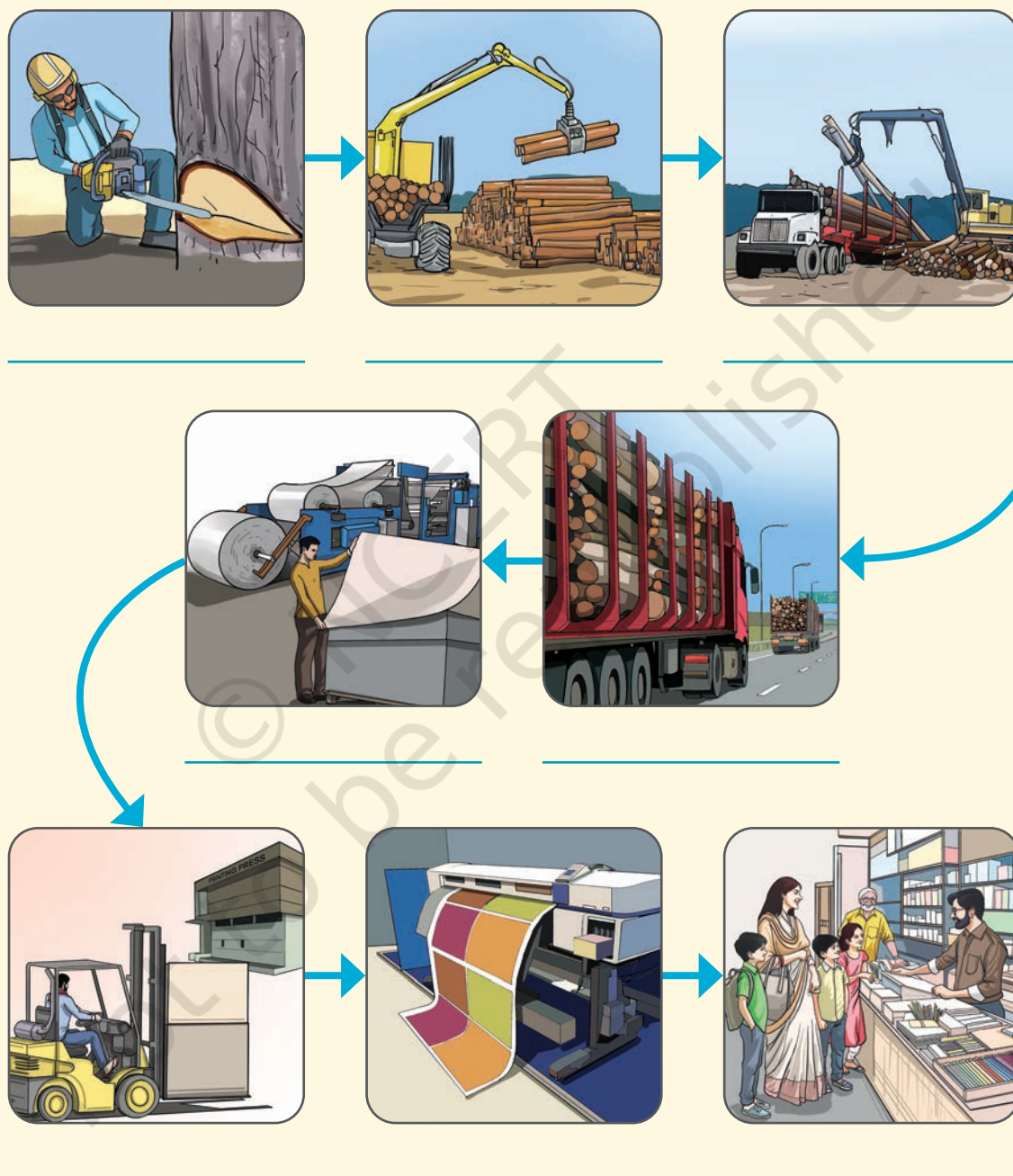


Fig. 14.1

None of the activities that were part of the process – from extracting pulp from the trees to making paper and finally producing the books would have been possible, had it not been for all three sectors working together.



THINK ABOUT IT

Observe the different stages of the process shown in Fig. 14.1 on page 206 and discuss them with your fellow classmates.

LET'S EXPLORE

Label the pictures in the illustration shown in Fig. 14.1 on page 206 as:

1. Primary sector
2. Secondary sector
3. Tertiary sector



DON'T MISS OUT

These days, used paper is recycled to make new paper. Recycling just one tonne of paper saves 17 trees as well as 2.5 cubic metres of landfill space, where waste is dumped. It also takes 70 per cent less energy and water to recycle paper than to make new paper from wood pulp.



What are the different ways through which we can judiciously use paper in the classrooms and offices of your school?

LET'S EXPLORE



List the economic activities in your neighbourhood and label them appropriately as primary, secondary or tertiary. Draw arrows to show how they are connected to each other. In what ways are they dependent on each other? What would happen if one of the activities ceased to exist?



Before we move on...

- In this chapter, we learnt about the three sectors of economic activities.
- The various examples and illustrations helped to understand the difference as well as the interdependence between the three types of economic activities or sectors — primary, secondary and tertiary.

Questions, activities and projects

1. What is the primary sector? How is it different from the secondary sector? Give two examples.
2. How does the secondary sector depend on the tertiary sector? Illustrate with a few examples.
3. Give an example of interdependence between primary, secondary and tertiary sectors. Show it using a flow diagram.